

HTML INTERVIEW HANDBOOK

Basic to Advanced

Short Answers, Examples and Interview Tips

Fresher to 5 Years Experience

119 Interview Questions

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Full Stack Developer Interview Series - Volume 1

1. HTML Basics

Q1. What is HTML?

Answer: HTML is the standard markup language used to structure web pages.

```
<h1>Hello</h1>
```

Tip: HTML gives structure; CSS gives style.

Q2. What does HTML stand for?

Answer: HyperText Markup Language.

Tip: Say the full form clearly.

Q3. Is HTML a programming language?

Answer: No. It is a markup language; it does not contain programming logic by itself.

Tip: Do not call HTML a programming language.

Q4. What is HTML5?

Answer: HTML5 is the modern HTML standard with semantic tags, multimedia and browser APIs.

```
<video controls></video>
```

Tip: Mention semantic tags and native media.

Q5. What is a tag?

Answer: A tag is markup written inside angle brackets.

```
<p>Text</p>
```

Tip: Most tags have opening and closing forms.

Q6. What is an element?

Answer: An element includes the opening tag, content and closing tag.

```
<h2>Title</h2>
```

Tip: Tag and element are not exactly the same.

Q7. What is an attribute?

Answer: An attribute adds extra information to an element.

```

```

Tip: Attributes are placed in the opening tag.

Q8. What is the basic HTML document structure?

Answer: A document normally has DOCTYPE, html, head and body.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head></head>
<body></body>
</html>
```

Tip: Memorize the basic skeleton.

Q9. What is DOCTYPE?

Answer: DOCTYPE tells the browser to render the page in standards mode.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
```

Tip: It should be the first line.

Q10. What are void elements?

Answer: Void elements do not require a closing tag.

```
<br> <hr> <img> <input> <meta> <link>
```

Tip: Do not add content inside void elements.

Q11. What is nesting in HTML?

Answer: Nesting means placing one element inside another.

```
<div><p>Hello</p></div>
```

Tip: Close elements in reverse order.

Q12. What is the difference between block and inline elements?

Answer: Block elements start on a new line; inline elements use only needed width.

```
<div>Block</div> <span>Inline</span>
```

Tip: CSS can change display behavior.

2. Head, Meta and Document Information

Q13. What is the purpose of the head tag?

Answer: It stores metadata, title, styles, scripts and resource links.

```
<head><title>Home</title></head>
```

Tip: Head content is not the main visible page content.

Q14. What does the title tag do?

Answer: It sets the browser tab title and helps SEO.

```
<title>Product Page</title>
```

Tip: Use a unique title for every page.

Q15. What is a meta tag?

Answer: A meta tag provides information about the document to browsers and search engines.

```
<meta name="description" content="Page summary">
```

Tip: Meta tags are placed inside head.

Q16. Why use the viewport meta tag?

Answer: It helps pages scale correctly on mobile devices.

```
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
```

Tip: Essential for responsive design.

Q17. What is character encoding?

Answer: It tells the browser how characters are represented.

```
<meta charset="UTF-8">
```

Tip: UTF-8 supports most languages.

Q18. What is a favicon?

Answer: A favicon is the small icon shown in the browser tab.

```
<link rel="icon" href="favicon.ico">
```

Tip: Use a small optimized image.

Q19. How do you link an external CSS file?

Answer: Use the link element inside head.

```
<link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">
```

Tip: Prefer external CSS for maintainability.

Q20. How do you include JavaScript?

Answer: Use the script element with src for external files.

```
<script src="app.js" defer></script>
```

Tip: Use defer for most page scripts.

Q21. What is the defer attribute?

Answer: It downloads the script in parallel and runs it after HTML parsing.

```
<script src="app.js" defer></script>
```

Tip: Execution order is preserved.

Q22. What is the async attribute?

Answer: It downloads in parallel and runs as soon as ready.

```
<script src="analytics.js" async></script>
```

Tip: Order is not guaranteed.

3. Text and Formatting

Q23. What is the difference between h1 and p?

Answer: h1 defines a top-level heading; p defines a paragraph.

```
<h1>Title</h1><p>Text</p>
```

Tip: Usually keep one main h1 per page.

Q24. What are heading tags?

Answer: h1 to h6 define headings from highest to lowest importance.

```
<h1>Main</h1><h2>Sub</h2>
```

Tip: Use headings in logical order.

Q25. What is the difference between strong and b?

Answer: strong gives semantic importance; b only adds visual boldness.

```
<strong>Warning</strong> <b>Label</b>
```

Tip: Prefer strong for meaningful emphasis.

Q26. What is the difference between em and i?

Answer: em gives semantic emphasis; i is mainly visual or alternate voice.

```
<em>Important</em> <i>Term</i>
```

Tip: Prefer em for meaning.

Q27. What does br do?

Answer: It inserts a line break.

```
Line 1<br>Line 2
```

Tip: Do not use br for page layout.

Q28. What does hr do?

Answer: It represents a thematic break between sections.

```
<hr>
```

Tip: Use CSS for appearance.

Q29. What is preformatted text?

Answer: The pre element preserves spaces and line breaks.

```
<pre>Line 1
  Line 2</pre>
```

Tip: Useful for code and fixed formatting.

Q30. What is the code tag?

Answer: It marks a fragment as computer code.

```
<code>const x = 1;</code>
```

Tip: Use pre + code for blocks.

Q31. What is the mark tag?

Answer: It highlights text as relevant.

```
<mark>Important</mark>
```

Tip: Use only when highlighting has meaning.

Q32. What is the small tag?

Answer: It represents side comments or small print.

```
<small>Terms apply</small>
```

Tip: Good for legal or secondary text.

4. Links, Images and Paths

Q33. How do you create a hyperlink?

Answer: Use the anchor element with href.

```
<a href="https://example.com">Visit</a>
```

Tip: Use meaningful link text.

Q34. What is an absolute URL?

Answer: A full URL including protocol and domain.

```
<a href="https://example.com/page">Link</a>
```

Tip: Best for external links.

Q35. What is a relative URL?

Answer: A path relative to the current file or site.

```
<a href="about.html">About</a>
```

Tip: Best for internal links.

Q36. How do you open a link in a new tab?

Answer: Use target="_blank".

```
<a href="https://example.com" target="_blank" rel="noopener">Open</a>
```

Tip: Add rel="noopener" for security.

Q37. What is the purpose of rel="noopener"?

Answer: It prevents the new page from accessing the opener window.

```
<a target="_blank" rel="noopener">
```

Tip: Use it with new-tab links.

Q38. How do you link to a section on the same page?

Answer: Use a fragment identifier that matches an element id.

```
<a href="#contact">Contact</a>
<section id="contact"></section>
```

Tip: IDs must be unique.

Q39. How do you display an image?

Answer: Use the img element with src and alt.

```

```

Tip: Always provide useful alt text.

Q40. Why is alt text important?

Answer: It supports screen readers and appears when an image fails.

```

```

Tip: Describe meaning, not every visual detail.

Q41. What are width and height attributes used for?

Answer: They reserve image space and reduce layout shift.

```

```

Tip: Use correct aspect ratio.

Q42. What is the picture element?

Answer: It provides different image sources for responsive or format needs.

```
<picture><source srcset="a.webp" type="image/webp"></picture>
```

Tip: Useful for art direction and modern formats.

Q43. What is srcset?

Answer: It lets the browser choose an appropriate image by size or density.

```

```

Tip: Combine with sizes when needed.

Q44. What is lazy loading for images?

Answer: It delays loading off-screen images.

```

```

Tip: Do not lazy-load the main hero image.

5. Lists and Tables

Q45. What are the main list types?

Answer: Ordered, unordered and description lists.

```
<ul><li>A</li></ul>
<ol><li>One</li></ol>
```

Tip: Choose by meaning, not appearance.

Q46. What is an unordered list?

Answer: A list where order is not important.

```
<ul><li>HTML</li><li>CSS</li></ul>
```

Tip: Default bullets can be styled with CSS.

Q47. What is an ordered list?

Answer: A list where sequence matters.

```
<ol><li>Install</li><li>Run</li></ol>
```

Tip: Use start or reversed if required.

Q48. What is a description list?

Answer: A list of terms and descriptions.

```
<dl><dt>HTML</dt><dd>Markup language</dd></dl>
```

Tip: Good for glossaries.

Q49. What tags create a table?

Answer: table, thead, tbody, tr, th and td.

```
<table><tr><th>Name</th><td>Ana</td></tr></table>
```

Tip: Use tables only for tabular data.

Q50. What is the difference between th and td?

Answer: th is a header cell; td is a data cell.

```
<th scope="col">Name</th><td>Sam</td>
```

Tip: Use scope for accessibility.

Q51. Why use thead, tbody and tfoot?

Answer: They group table sections for structure, styling and accessibility.

```
<table><thead>...</thead><tbody>...</tbody></table>
```

Tip: Helpful for large tables.

Q52. What do colspan and rowspan do?

Answer: They make cells span multiple columns or rows.

```
<td colspan="2">Total</td>
```

Tip: Use carefully; complex tables reduce accessibility.

Q53. What is a table caption?

Answer: A caption describes the table.

```
<table><caption>Monthly Sales</caption></table>
```

Tip: Place it inside table, first child.

6. Forms

Q54. What is the form element?

Answer: It groups controls used to collect and submit user data.

```
<form action="/save" method="post"></form>
```

Tip: Set action and method clearly.

Q55. What is the difference between GET and POST?

Answer: GET sends data in the URL; POST sends it in the request body.

```
<form method="post">
```

Tip: Do not use GET for sensitive data.

Q56. Why is the name attribute important?

Answer: Only named controls are included in form submission.

```
<input name="email">
```

Tip: id alone is not enough for submission.

Q57. What is a label element?

Answer: It connects descriptive text to a form control.

```
<label for="email">Email</label><input id="email">
```

Tip: Improves accessibility and click area.

Q58. How do you associate a label with an input?

Answer: Match label for with input id.

```
<label for="age">Age</label><input id="age" name="age">
```

Tip: IDs should be unique.

Q59. What are common input types?

Answer: text, email, password, number, date, checkbox, radio, file and submit.

```
<input type="email">
```

Tip: Use the most specific type.

Q60. What is the difference between checkbox and radio?

Answer: Checkbox allows multiple choices; radio selects one option in a group.

```
<input type="radio" name="plan" value="basic">
```

Tip: Radio buttons share the same name.

Q61. What does required do?

Answer: It prevents submission when the control is empty.

```
<input type="email" required>
```

Tip: Still validate on the server.

Q62. What is placeholder?

Answer: It shows a short hint inside a control.

```
<input placeholder="name@example.com">
```

Tip: Placeholder is not a replacement for label.

Q63. What is the difference between disabled and readonly?

Answer: Disabled fields cannot be edited or submitted; readonly fields are submitted.

```
<input value="123" readonly>
```

Tip: Disabled values are omitted from submission.

Q64. What is the select element?

Answer: It creates a dropdown list.

```
<select name="city"><option>Chennai</option></select>
```

Tip: Give options meaningful values.

Q65. What is textarea?

Answer: It creates a multi-line text input.

```
<textarea name="message" rows="4"></textarea>
```

Tip: Use CSS to control size.

Q66. What is fieldset?

Answer: It groups related form controls.

```
<fieldset><legend>Address</legend>...</fieldset>
```

Tip: Useful for accessibility.

Q67. What is datalist?

Answer: It provides suggestions for an input.

```
<input list="cities"><datalist id="cities"><option value="Chennai"></datalist>
```

Tip: Users can still enter another value.

Q68. What is input pattern?

Answer: It validates text using a regular expression.

```
<input pattern="[0-9]{10}">
```

Tip: Add a clear validation message.

Q69. How do you upload a file?

Answer: Use input type file and multipart form encoding.

```
<form enctype="multipart/form-data"><input type="file" name="doc"></form>
```

Tip: Validate file type and size on server.

Q70. What is autocomplete?

Answer: It controls browser autofill behavior.

```
<input name="email" autocomplete="email">
```

Tip: Use correct autocomplete tokens.

Q71. What is novalidate?

Answer: It disables built-in browser validation for the form.

```
<form novalidate>
```

Tip: Use only when custom validation is provided.

7. Semantic HTML and Accessibility

Q72. What is semantic HTML?

Answer: It uses elements that describe the role of content.

```
<main><article>...</article></main>
```

Tip: Improves accessibility and SEO.

Q73. What is the purpose of header?

Answer: It represents introductory content for a page or section.

```
<header><h1>Site</h1></header>
```

Tip: A page may contain multiple headers.

Q74. What is nav used for?

Answer: It wraps major navigation links.

```
<nav><a href="/">Home</a></nav>
```

Tip: Not every group of links needs nav.

Q75. What is main used for?

Answer: It contains the primary content of the document.

```
<main>...</main>
```

Tip: Normally one visible main per page.

Q76. What is article used for?

Answer: It represents self-contained content that can stand alone.

```
<article><h2>News</h2></article>
```

Tip: Examples: post, card, comment.

Q77. What is section used for?

Answer: It groups related content, usually with a heading.

```
<section><h2>Features</h2></section>
```

Tip: Do not use section only for styling.

Q78. What is aside used for?

Answer: It contains related but secondary content.

```
<aside>Related links</aside>
```

Tip: Examples: sidebar, note, advert.

Q79. What is footer used for?

Answer: It contains footer information for a page or section.

```
<footer>Copyright</footer>
```

Tip: A page can have multiple footers.

Q80. Why is heading order important?

Answer: Logical heading levels help screen readers and document navigation.

```
<h1>Page</h1><h2>Section</h2>
```

Tip: Avoid skipping levels without reason.

Q81. What is ARIA?

Answer: ARIA adds accessibility information when native HTML is not enough.

```
<button aria-expanded="false">Menu</button>
```

Tip: Prefer native semantic HTML first.

Q82. What is aria-label?

Answer: It provides an accessible name when visible text is missing.

```
<button aria-label="Close">x</button>
```

Tip: Do not duplicate visible text unnecessarily.

Q83. What is tabindex?

Answer: It controls keyboard focus order or focusability.

```
<div tabindex="0">Focusable</div>
```

Tip: Avoid positive tabindex values.

Q84. What is a skip link?

Answer: It lets keyboard users jump directly to main content.

```
<a href="#main">Skip to content</a>
```

Tip: Make it visible on focus.

Q85. Why should buttons be buttons, not divs?

Answer: Buttons provide keyboard support, semantics and accessibility by default.

```
<button type="button">Save</button>
```

Tip: Use native controls whenever possible.

8. Media, iframe, Canvas and SVG

Q86. How do you add audio?

Answer: Use the audio element with controls.

```
<audio controls src="song.mp3"></audio>
```

Tip: Provide fallback text if needed.

Q87. How do you add video?

Answer: Use the video element with controls.

```
<video controls width="640" src="movie.mp4"></video>
```

Tip: Use captions for accessibility.

Q88. What is the source element?

Answer: It provides multiple media sources.

```
<video controls><source src="a.mp4" type="video/mp4"></video>
```

Tip: Browser picks a supported source.

Q89. What are track elements?

Answer: They add captions, subtitles or descriptions to media.

```
<track kind="captions" src="captions.vtt" srclang="en">
```

Tip: Important for accessibility.

Q90. What is an iframe?

Answer: It embeds another page or document inside the current page.

```
<iframe src="https://example.com" title="Example"></iframe>
```

Tip: Always add a title.

Q91. How can iframe security be improved?

Answer: Use sandbox and restrictive allow settings.

```
<iframe src="page.html" sandbox="allow-scripts"></iframe>
```

Tip: Grant only required permissions.

Q92. What is canvas?

Answer: Canvas is a script-driven bitmap drawing area.

```
<canvas id="chart" width="300" height="150"></canvas>
```

Tip: Good for dynamic graphics.

Q93. What is SVG?

Answer: SVG is XML-based vector graphics that scale without quality loss.

```
<svg width="100" height="100"><circle cx="50" cy="50" r="40"/></svg>
```

Tip: Good for icons and diagrams.

Q94. Canvas vs SVG?

Answer: Canvas is pixel-based; SVG is vector and DOM-based.

Tip: Canvas suits many dynamic pixels; SVG suits scalable shapes.

9. Storage, Performance and SEO

Q95. What is localStorage?

Answer: It stores string data in the browser without automatic expiry.

```
localStorage.setItem("theme", "dark")
```

Tip: Do not store sensitive data.

Q96. What is sessionStorage?

Answer: It stores data for the current browser tab session.

```
sessionStorage.setItem("step", "2")
```

Tip: Cleared when the tab closes.

Q97. localStorage vs cookies?

Answer: localStorage is client-only storage; cookies can be sent with requests.

Tip: Cookies support expiry and security flags.

Q98. What is the loading attribute?

Answer: It controls lazy loading for images and iframes.

```
<iframe loading="lazy" src="map.html"></iframe>
```

Tip: Use for below-the-fold content.

Q99. How does semantic HTML help SEO?

Answer: It clarifies page structure and content meaning for search engines.

```
<article><h2>Guide</h2></article>
```

Tip: Also improves accessibility.

Q100. What makes a good meta description?

Answer: A short, unique summary that matches page content.

```
<meta name="description" content="Learn HTML interview questions with examples.">
```

Tip: Avoid duplicate descriptions.

Q101. What is canonical URL?

Answer: It tells search engines the preferred URL for duplicate content.

```
<link rel="canonical" href="https://site.com/page">
```

Tip: Use one preferred URL.

Q102. Why use lang on html?

Answer: It identifies the page language for browsers and assistive tools.

```
<html lang="en">
```

Tip: Use the correct language code.

Q103. What is preload?

Answer: It tells the browser to fetch an important resource early.

```
<link rel="preload" href="font.woff2" as="font" crossorigin>
```

Tip: Use sparingly.

Q104. What is preconnect?

Answer: It starts an early connection to another origin.

```
<link rel="preconnect" href="https://fonts.example.com">
```

Tip: Useful for critical third-party origins.

10. Advanced and Scenario Questions

Q105. How do you make a custom data attribute?

Answer: Use attributes beginning with data-.

```
<button data-user-id="42">View</button>
```

Tip: Read it in JS through dataset.

Q106. What is contenteditable?

Answer: It makes an element editable in the browser.

```
<div contenteditable="true">Edit me</div>
```

Tip: Sanitize saved content.

Q107. What is the hidden attribute?

Answer: It hides content from rendering.

```
<div hidden>Secret</div>
```

Tip: Do not use it for security.

Q108. What is the download attribute?

Answer: It suggests that a link should download a resource.

```
<a href="guide.pdf" download>Download</a>
```

Tip: Browser and origin rules may apply.

Q109. What is the role attribute?

Answer: It gives an element an accessibility role.

```
<div role="alert">Error</div>
```

Tip: Native elements are usually better.

Q110. How do you create a responsive form?

Answer: Use semantic controls, labels, flexible widths and responsive CSS.

```
<input type="email" name="email">
```

Tip: HTML structure first; CSS handles layout.

Q111. How would you improve a form with only placeholders?

Answer: Add visible labels, proper input types, autocomplete and error messages.

Tip: Placeholders disappear while typing.

Q112. Why is duplicate id a problem?

Answer: IDs must be unique; duplicates break labels, anchors and JavaScript targeting.

```
<label for="email">...</label><input id="email">
```

Tip: Use classes for repeated styling.

Q113. A button inside a form submits unexpectedly. Why?

Answer: The default button type inside a form is submit.

```
<button type="button">Open</button>
```

Tip: Set type explicitly.

Q114. Why is an image not accessible even with alt?

Answer: The alt text may be empty, vague or unrelated to the image purpose.

```

```

Tip: Write purpose-based alt text.

Q115. How do you make a decorative image accessible?

Answer: Use empty alt so screen readers ignore it.

```

```

Tip: Do not add meaningless words like decoration.

Q116. A table is hard for screen readers. How do you improve it?

Answer: Add caption, th cells, scope and a simple structure.

```
<th scope="col">Price</th>
```

Tip: Avoid unnecessary merged cells.

Q117. How do you avoid layout shift caused by images?

Answer: Set width and height or CSS aspect-ratio.

```

```

Tip: Reserve space before loading.

Q118. Why should interactive divs be avoided?

Answer: They lack keyboard behavior and semantics.

```
<button type="button">Menu</button>
```

Tip: Use button or link depending on action.

Q119. How do you validate HTML?

Answer: Use an HTML validator and browser developer tools.

Tip: Fix invalid nesting and duplicate IDs.

Quick Final Revision

- Use semantic elements before adding ARIA.
- Always connect labels to form controls.
- Use meaningful alt text; use empty alt for decorative images.
- Set button type explicitly inside forms.
- Use one main element and logical heading order.
- Use responsive images, width/height and lazy loading correctly.
- Validate HTML and avoid duplicate IDs.

End of HTML Interview Handbook